

Student Leave Policy

School of Technology · Office of the Dean of Student Affairs Document ref.: SL/2026 ·

Effective from: Academic Year 2026-27 (Odd Semester, 16 June 2026) · **Supersedes:** SL/2024

1. Purpose and scope

1.1 This policy sets out how an undergraduate student applies for leave of absence from classes, who decides the application, the limits on leave, and the effect of approved leave on attendance under Part IV (Attendance) of the Academic Regulations.

1.2 It applies to absence from scheduled sessions of enrolled courses. It does not govern absence from an internal test or examination, which is dealt with under Part V clause 4, nor withdrawal from the programme, which is dealt with under the Fee Policy (FP/2026) clause 7.

1.3 Leave is a concession, not an entitlement. The University expects students to attend every scheduled session, and a student on approved leave remains responsible for the work covered in the sessions missed.

2. Kinds of leave

2.1 **Medical leave** — absence on account of the student's own illness or injury.

2.2 **Personal leave** — absence for a family event, a religious observance, travel with the family, an appointment that cannot be scheduled outside teaching hours, or a comparable personal reason.

2.3 **Duty leave** — absence to represent the University in a sports, cultural, technical or academic event, including an inter-collegiate competition, a hackathon, a conference or an industrial visit organised by a department.

2.4 **Emergency leave** — absence on account of a sudden event (a family emergency, an accident, a natural calamity) that made it impossible to apply in advance; regularised after the event under clause 6.

3. Application

3.1 A student applies for leave **through the student portal**, stating the first and last dates of the leave (inclusive), the kind of leave, and the reason. The application is routed automatically to the approving authority in clause 4.

3.2 An application must be submitted **before the leave begins**. Except for emergency leave under clause 6, an application for a period that has already begun is not accepted by the portal.

3.3 **A single application may cover a period of not more than ten (10) consecutive calendar days**, counting the first and last dates. A longer absence requires a fresh application for each period, and an absence expected to exceed thirty days in a semester is treated under clause 7.

3.4 A student may not hold two leave applications for overlapping dates. The portal rejects an application whose dates overlap a request that is *pending* or *approved*. A student who needs to change the dates of a pending request withdraws it and applies afresh.

3.5 Supporting documents:

3.5.1 **Medical leave** of more than two days must be supported by a certificate from a registered medical practitioner stating the period of incapacity, uploaded with the application or within three days of return. Medical leave of one or two days needs no certificate but may not be taken more than three times in a semester without one.

3.5.2 **Duty leave** must be supported by the invitation, selection letter or event notice, and is endorsed by the faculty coordinator of the event or the Director of Physical Education before it reaches the approving authority.

3.5.3 **Personal leave** needs no document for up to three days; for longer periods the approving authority may ask for evidence of the reason.

4. Approving authority

4.1 **Leave applications are decided by the Head of the Department in which the student is enrolled.** In the Head's absence the application is decided by the faculty member nominated as acting Head, and the decision is recorded in the Head's name.

4.2 Duty leave for an event organised by another department or by the University is nonetheless decided by the Head of the student's own department, on the endorsement in clause 3.5.2.

4.3 The Head of Department decides each application within **three working days** of its submission, recording the decision — *approved* or *rejected* — and, for a rejection, the reason, on the portal. A student is notified on the portal and by e-mail.

4.4 An application not decided within three working days remains *pending* and the student may bring it to the attention of the Dean of Student Affairs, who may decide it in the Head's place.

4.5 A student may request reconsideration of a rejection once, within three working days, stating additional grounds; the Head's decision on reconsideration is final.

5. Limits on leave

5.1 Personal leave is limited to **ten days in a semester**, whether taken in one or several periods. Applications beyond this limit are rejected unless the Head of Department, recording reasons, finds the circumstances exceptional.

5.2 Medical leave and duty leave are not subject to a fixed limit, but the Head of Department may refer a student whose medical leave exceeds fifteen days in a semester to the University medical officer, and may decline duty leave that would cause the student's attendance in any course to fall below the condonation floor in Part IV clause 5.2.

5.3 Leave is not granted for a day on which the student has an internal test or a laboratory examination, other than medical or duty leave supported under clause 3.5. Absence from an assessment is dealt with under Part V clause 4.

5.4 Leave is not required for notified holidays or breaks, or for sessions cancelled by the instructor, since no sessions are held on those days.

6. Emergency leave and regularisation

6.1 A student who is absent because of an emergency informs the Head of Department or the class coordinator by e-mail or telephone as soon as practicable, and applies for leave on the portal **within three working days of returning** to the University, marking the application as emergency leave and stating why advance application was not possible.

6.2 The Head of Department may approve emergency leave with retrospective effect if satisfied that the reason was genuine and the delay unavoidable. Absence for which regularisation is refused, or for which no application is made within the period in clause 6.1, remains absence without leave.

7. Prolonged absence

7.1 A student who expects to be absent for more than thirty days in a semester — for instance on account of a serious illness — applies to the Dean (Academics) for a **semester break**, supported by medical or other evidence. A semester break withdraws the student from all courses of the semester without academic penalty; the student re-registers for the semester on return, and the fee paid is carried forward under the Fee Policy.

7.2 A student absent without leave for thirty consecutive teaching days is issued a notice by the Head of Department, and if no satisfactory response is received within fifteen days, is treated as having withdrawn from the programme.

8. Effect of approved leave on attendance

8.1 For every session of an enrolled course falling within a period of approved leave, the student is recorded in the University attendance system as **excused leave**, which under Part IV clause 2.3 counts as *attended* for the purpose of the attendance percentage.

8.2 **Not more than ten (10) sessions of excused leave per course in a semester are counted as attended** under clause 8.1; excused-leave sessions beyond that number are recorded but are treated as *absent* in computing the percentage. Duty leave under clause 2.3 is not subject to this cap.

8.3 Absence that is not covered by an approved leave request — whether because no application was made, because the application was rejected, or because regularisation under clause 6 was refused — is recorded as *absent* and counts against the student's attendance percentage. Such absence may still be a ground for condonation under Part IV clause 5.3 if the reason falls within that clause.

8.4 Approved leave does not excuse a student from any assessment falling within the leave period; the student applies separately under Part V clause 4.2 for a make-up where that clause allows.

9. Records

9.1 The student portal shows every leave request of the student with its dates, reason, status, the date it was applied for, and, once decided, the date of decision. This record is available to the student, the Head of Department and the course instructors of the student's enrolled courses.

10. Review

10.1 This policy is reviewed every two years by the Students' Welfare Committee, which reports to the Academic Council.